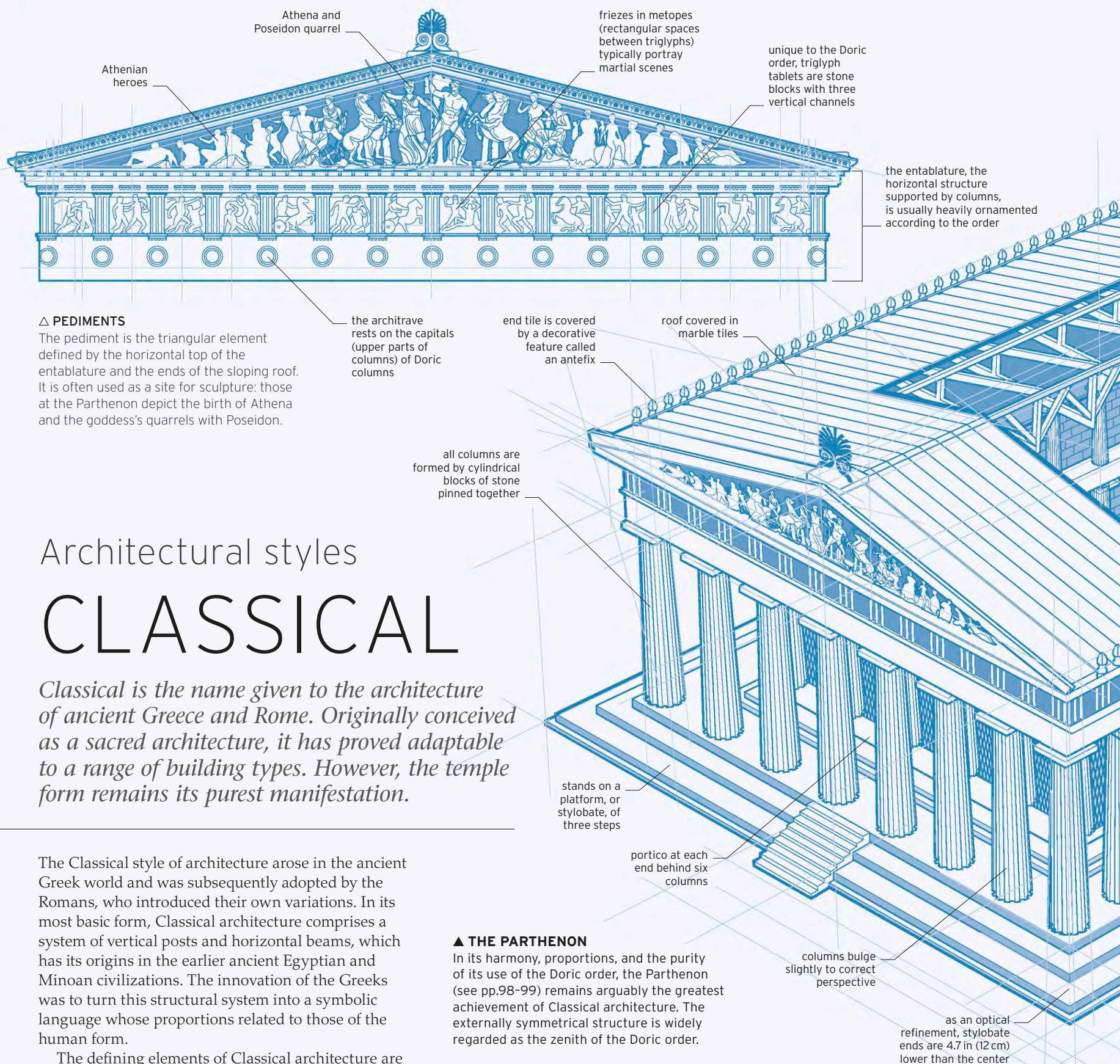




△ PEDIMENTS

The pediment is the triangular element defined by the horizontal top of the entablature and the ends of the sloping roof. It is often used as a site for sculpture: those at the Parthenon depict the birth of Athena and the goddess's quarrels with Poseidon.

Architectural styles CLASSICAL

Classical is the name given to the architecture of ancient Greece and Rome. Originally conceived as a sacred architecture, it has proved adaptable to a range of building types. However, the temple form remains its purest manifestation.

The Classical style of architecture arose in the ancient Greek world and was subsequently adopted by the Romans, who introduced their own variations. In its most basic form, Classical architecture comprises a system of vertical posts and horizontal beams, which has its origins in the earlier ancient Egyptian and Minoan civilizations. The innovation of the Greeks was to turn this structural system into a symbolic language whose proportions related to those of the human form.

The defining elements of Classical architecture are the five orders: the Doric, Ionic, and Corinthian, later joined by the Tuscan and Composite. Although most easily identified by the particular type of column employed, the Classical order comprises the base, column, capital, and entablature, with each order having a predefined set of proportions and decorative schemes. It is this engaging combination of the structural and symbolic that lies at the heart of Classical architecture's enduring appeal.

▲ THE PARTHENON

In its harmony, proportions, and the purity of its use of the Doric order, the Parthenon (see pp.98-99) remains arguably the greatest achievement of Classical architecture. The externally symmetrical structure is widely regarded as the zenith of the Doric order.

In its original form, much **Greek and Roman** classical architecture **was not white**, as it appears now, but was painted in **bright colors**